Bioethics

What Is Bioethics?

Bioethics is the application of ethical principles to healthcare and medical practice.
It helps doctors decide **what should be done**.gnieb-llew dna ,ytefas ,seulav ,sthgir s'tneitap eht gniredisnoc elihw ,

Types of Ethics

- **Personal ethics:** Individual values such as honesty and integrity.
- **Professional ethics:** Standards governing professional behavior.
- **Medical ethics:** Ethical issues related to patient care.
- **Research ethics:** Protecting people involved in medical research.
- **Public health ethics:** Fairness and ethical decisions affecting communities.

Basic Principles of Bioethics

- **Autonomy:** Respect the patient's right to make informed decisions.
- **Beneficence:** Act in the patient's best interest.
- **Non-maleficence:** Avoid unnecessary harm.
- **Justice:** Treat patients fairly and equitably.
- **Confidentiality:** Protect patients' private information.
- **Dignity:** Treat every patient with respect.

Why Is Bioethics Important?

Knowledge of bioethics helps doctors to:
•Protect patients' rights and dignity.
•Build trust with patients and families.
•Make appropriate decisions in difficult situations.
•Communicate honestly and effectively.
•Manage issues such as informed consent and terminal illness.
•Promote professionalism, teamwork, and patient safety.

Obstacles to Proper Ethical Conduct

Common obstacles include:
•Uncertainty, especially in terminal illness and prognosis.
•Poor communication skills.
•Fear of the patient's or family's reaction.
•Believing that withholding information is "in the patient's best interest".
•Lack of adequate time for discussion.
•Language and communication barriers.
•Lack of teamwork or professional communication.

How Can We Improve Ethical Conduct?

Good Communication
•Listen actively to patients and families.
•Use clear and simple language.
•Provide adequate and truthful information.
•Allow time for questions.
•Check the patient's understanding.
•Use qualified interpreters when needed.

Professional Relationships

•Establish and maintain respectful relationships with patients and relatives.
•Respect patient rights, privacy, dignity, and choices.
•Respect colleagues and all members of the healthcare team.
•Communicate and work effectively as a team.

Access to Healthcare

•Help patients access appropriate healthcare services.
•Promote fair and equitable care.
•Avoid discrimination.

Ethical Practice: Remember

Respect –Listen –Inform –Communicate –Protect –Support
Every healthcare provider aim to provide care that is:
Competent + Compassionate + Honest + Respectful + Fair + Patient-centered
Key Message.

Good medical practice is not only about knowing what can be done; it is also about knowing what should be done ethically.